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Bill calls for social media ban for children

House leaders also seek cellphone limits in school; Healey likely to offer own plan

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts House lawmakers will vote Wednesday on legislation that would ban children under 14 from using social media, a measure they touted as among the country's strictest bids at regulating what kids consume online. The legislation, which would al-

so seek to ban cellphone use in schools, adds to a growing queue of plans on Beacon Hill to pare back technology's influence on children. That comes as health experts have increasingly warned of its detrimental effects for young people.

The proposal that Democratic leaders put out Monday would prohibit social media companies from

letting children under 14 years old have accounts on their platforms. Those social media platforms would also require parents to give "verifiable consent" for children who are 14 or 15 years old to use them, according to lawmakers.

"This ban would be among the most restrictive in the entire country, helping to protect young people from harmful content and addictive algorithms that have a proven negative impact on their mental health," House Speaker Ron Maria-

no and state Representative Aaron Michlewitz, the House's budget chief, said in a joint statement.

"The simple reality is that Massachusetts must do more to ensure that our laws keep pace with modern challenges — especially when it comes to protecting our children, and to setting students up for success in the classroom and beyond," the Democrats said.

The House's proposed ban comes months after Governor Mau-

SOCIAL MEDIA, Page A7

Cuts loom as Wu to file \$4.9b budget

Mayor says proposal would increase spending by 2%, trim some grant programs

By Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF

After warning about looming financial challenges, Mayor Michelle Wu on Monday said she'll file a \$4.9 billion budget proposal this week that would slice some grant programs she has championed and include the thinnest overall spending increase since the Great Recession.

Wu's spending plan, which she is due to unveil Wednesday, would hike spending by 2 percent over the current year's \$4.8 billion budget, which she called the smallest year-over-year increase the city has proposed since 2009. She did not offer many specifics on where departments may make cuts.

"Ask any mayor, and you'll hear that it is a difficult moment here in Boston, across the Commonwealth, and around the country," Wu said in a call with reporters Monday. "We are confronting serious cost pressures . . . [and] making careful choices to protect what matters most to residents."

Beyond what officials described as steep health insurance cost increases, the proposal would cut most departments' other spending by 1.3 percent, said Ashley Groffenberger, the city's chief financial officer.

Wu said the budget proposal cuts or scales back

BUDGET, Page A10

Overhaul for special needs faces hurdles

Advocates say loss of aides in classes sabotages effort

By Mariana Simões
GLOBE STAFF

Boston Public Schools promised to change how it teaches children with disabilities, vowing to have all kids learning in the same classrooms by 2027. The idea is to avoid separating students who need individualized instruction to improve learning and allow every child to feel included.

Now some educators and advocates worry budget cuts proposed by the city's School Committee could undercut that goal. The spending plan would eliminate more than 100 classroom aides this fall, axing vital support staff that help teach the city's most vulnerable students.

Critics contend cutting paraprofessionals, who on average make \$60,000 a year, could undermine efforts to make all classrooms inclusive, where children with and without disabilities learn side by side.

"Without that level of support, the inclusion model just can't reach its full potential," said Edith

AIDES, Page A10



PHOTOS BY CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Many drivers will be taking soccer fans from their taxi pool at Logan Airport to Foxborough during the World Cup in June.

By Laura Crimaldi
GLOBE STAFF

Come the World Cup in June, all roads will lead to Foxborough.

And some of the smallest players in the local transportation economy — rideshare drivers, cabbies, and families who plan to turn their front lawns into parking lots on match days — are clamoring for what they hope will be a cash cow.

"We are waiting to get some action," said Balwinder Gill, an Everett resident who has been driving a taxi in Greater Boston for 30 years. "We will be busy. I mean, that's what we're hoping."

And still some say they aren't quite so sure, treading cautiously as they await further plans for how Gillette Stadium will host the world's biggest tournament.

Ellen Davis, who has run a satellite parking lot on her Foxborough property for more than 20 years, said she can't gauge demand amid talk of reduced parking near the stadium and a push to steer fans onto public transit.

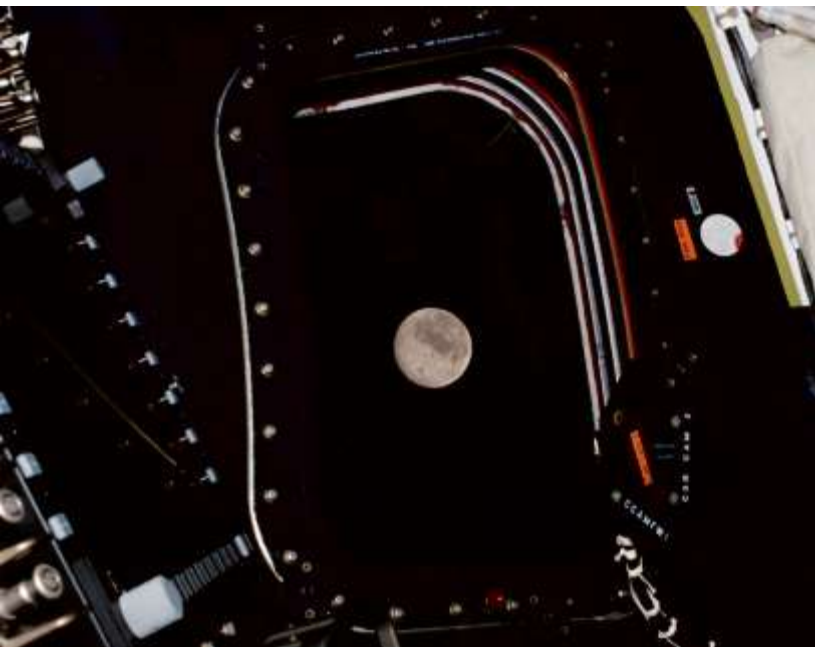
TRANSIT, Page A7



Cabbie Balwinder Gill: "We will be busy. I mean, that's what we're hoping."

A record venture to far side of the moon

Astronauts set distance mark from Earth as they whip through space



NASA/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

An Artemis II crew member sent an image of the moon on Monday.

By Kenneth Chang, Katrina Miller, and Thomas Fuller
NEW YORK TIMES

Four astronauts aboard a NASA spacecraft ventured farther from Earth than any humans in history as they swung toward the far side of the moon, seeing parts of the lunar surface never before observed with human eyes.

Back on Earth — in the United States, specifically — the milestone occurred Monday 1:56 p.m. Eastern time. But in the vastness of deep space, the astronauts called it Flight Day 6.

Their distance from Earth passed 248,655 miles, the record that had been set by the astronauts of Apollo 13 in 1970.

After Artemis II passed the record, Jenni Gibbons, the astronaut at mission control in Houston charged with communicating with the astronauts, gave details of the Apollo 13 mission 56 years ago.

"Today, for all humanity, you're pushing beyond that frontier," she said.

To commemorate the milestone, the Artemis II astronauts called down to mission control requesting that a previously unnamed crater that strad-

MOON, Page A6

The DNA of former Stoughton police officer Matthew Farwell was found on the weapon used to asphyxiate Sandra Birchmore, prosecutors said. **B1.**

A legislative committee passed a bill that would reduce the size of the state's Cannabis Control Commission. **D1.**

President Trump broadened his threat against Iran to include all power plants and bridges if the Strait of Hormuz is not opened by Tuesday night. **A5.**

Hamas must demilitarize in the Gaza Strip by the end of the week, the Board of Peace has reportedly told the militant group. **A3.**

Michigan muscled its way to the national title, beating UConn, 69-63, in the NCAA men's championship game. **C1.**



A snow-called spring

Tuesday: Rain, snow mix. High 43-48, low 27-32.

Wednesday: Even cooler. High 39-44, low 30-35.

High tide: 3:13, 3:53.

Sunrise: 6:17. Sunset: 7:17.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C10.**

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